

TikTok's Potential Ban in U.S. Sparks Debates with Quinnipiac University Community

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Hamden, Connecticut — Amid growing tensions between the U.S. and China, a proposed ban on the app TikTok has sparked debate among community members of Quinnipiac University.

On March 13, the House of Representatives voted 352-65 to pass a bill requiring ByteDance, the Chinese parent company of TikTok, to sell the app or face a nationwide ban in the United States.

The bill argues that China's intelligence laws could force ByteDance to give U.S. user data to the Chinese Communist Party or manipulate content displayed on its platform. In order for the bill to become law, it still needs to be passed by the Senate and signed by the president.

Since then, students and staff at Quinnipiac have been divided on the U.S. government's decision and the potential impact of the ban.

Zach Stokinger, 18, a first-year journalism student and avid social media user, questioned the importance of a ban, pointing to similar data-collection practices also done by American companies. As for social media consumption, he believes users would quickly adapt and move to a new site.

“I think it’s gonna be two weeks of, ‘Oh wait, I can’t use TikTok,’ and it’s just gonna switch over to Instagram Reels, and then that’s going to become the status quo,” Stokinger said.

Josh Brazinski, 19, a first-year film, TV, and media arts major, said he sees possible benefits from a ban. He explained how he believes less screen time could improve mental health for the majority of users.

Brazinski stated that he recently decreased his short-form content intake on social media as part of a “dopamine cleanse,” and he began to realize how much more free time he had after removing it from his routine.

“I think a lot of other people would grow to realize that that's a good thing,” Brazinski said. “You don't need constant stimulation...we look for it, and we want it because we've been conditioned to want it.”

Zoe Matzelle, 18, also a film, TV, and media arts freshman, criticized the government’s focus on banning the platform, stating that they “have way bigger things...they should be prioritizing.”

While Matzelle is aware of the concerns regarding privacy on TikTok, she questioned the urgency of a ban, as many other tech companies do similar practices without consequences.

Jim O’Connor, studio production manager and part-time professor at Quinnipiac, expressed his strong disapproval of the

government's decision, calling it "possibly the worst idea they've ever produced."

O'Connor mentioned that many people rely on TikTok for their livelihood and that according to Oxford Economics, over 7 million small businesses use the app to drive growth and sales.

He also explained the personal impact a ban would cause. "I run a few social media pages, so it would affect me in a large way," O'Connor said. "I think it would also discourage people from creating content, which would be very bad for our country. It would send a strong message that our government has a hidden agenda, in my opinion."

Regardless of the differing opinions on the ban, one thing remains certain: the future of TikTok will shape the landscape of social media and the lives of hundreds of millions of people in the United States, whether you are an active user, a government official, or simply an observer.

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Website Sources:

- <https://www.oxfordeconomics.com/resource/tiktok-us/>

Interview Subjects:

- **Zach Stokinger** / Quinnipiac University ('27) / Journalism Major

- **Josh Brazinski** / Quinnipiac University ('26, '27) / Film, TV, and Media Arts Major
- **Zoe Matzelle** / Quinnipiac University ('26, '27) / Film, TV, and Media Arts Major
- **Jim O'Connor** / Media Production Specialist and Professor at Quinnipiac University